

26 Activities in progress

Use the present perfect continuous to talk about ongoing activities in the past. Use "for" and "since" to talk about the length or starting point of an activity.

-  **New language** Present perfect continuous
- Aa Vocabulary** Home improvements
-  **New skill** Talking about activities in the past

26.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

The present perfect continuous describes an activity that took place over a period of time in the recent past. The activity might just have stopped or might still be happening.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

I have been painting the house all day. I'm exhausted!

The past activity often affects the present moment.



26.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES THE PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

"I have" can be shortened to "I've."

I've been cooking this evening.
Now I have to do the dishes.

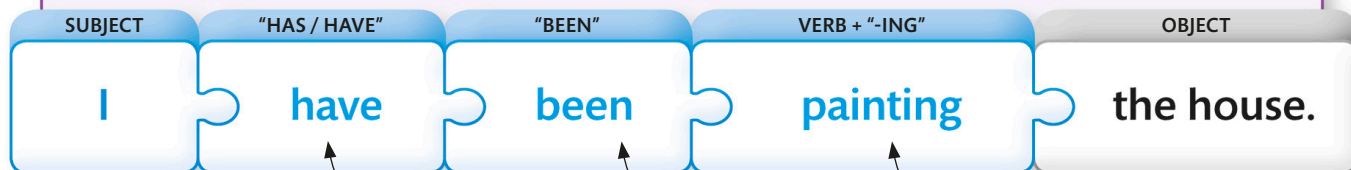


"He has" can be shortened to "He's."

He's been waiting for the bus for an hour.
He is going to be late for work.



26.3 HOW TO FORM THE PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS



Use "have" or "has," depending on the subject.

"Been" stays the same for all subjects.

Add "-ing" to the main verb.